Cameras Roll in Venice for the Sequel to 'Upgraded'

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Shooting is underway in Venice for "Upgraded 2," the **sequel** to Amazon MGM Studios' 2024 romantic comedy "Upgraded." Camila Mendes is returning as Ana Santos, and Leslie Bibb is set to star alongside her. So far, there are no indications of what Bibb's role is.

In the first film, Ana is an **intern** at a New York City auction house. She pretends to hold a higher job after she is upgraded to first class on her flight to London. During the flight, she impresses a wealthy young Englishman named William, played by Archie Renaux, who is connected to the high-society art world. The **sequel** is described as a modern-day "Cinderella" tale.

Cameras started rolling in Venice on October 21. In the **sequel**, Ana is now seemingly seeking to make her mark at the Venice **Biennale** art exhibition, described as the world's oldest contemporary art fair. Becca Gleason is directing the **sequel**, taking over from "Upgraded" director Carlson Young. Luke Roberts and Justin Matthews, who wrote the first film, also wrote the **screenplay** for the **sequel**.

Venice itself is part of the story. Gleason has been shooting on the terrace of Ca' Giustinian, the **Biennale** headquarters that overlooks the lagoon's Grand Canal. Filming has also taken place in the **neo-Gothic** Palazzo Franchetti near the Accademia bridge, which serves as a **Biennale** exhibition space, and at the Moro Venice restaurant.

The film will have a decidedly Italian flavor beyond Venice and the **Biennale**. After 12 days of shooting on the lagoon, **principal photography** will move to Rome, where 33 more days of shooting are planned, according to Italy for Movies. The production designer is Italy's Luca Tranchino, and the Italian company serving as executive producer on the **sequel** is Colorado Film.

Word Treasure

sequel -- A new film that continues the story of an earlier film.
intern -- A person who works for a short time, often to learn a job.
Biennale -- A large art exhibition that is held regularly in Venice.
screenplay -- The written script for a film, with its words and directions.
neo-Gothic -- A style that copies the pointed arches and decoration of Gothic buildings.
principal photography -- The main period when a film is actually shot with its actors.

Background you need

A sequel is a new film that continues a story and characters from an earlier film.

A romantic comedy mixes a love story with humour, and its characters often face a funny misunderstanding.

Filming on location means shooting in real places, not only in a studio, so a city can become part of how a film looks and feels.

An art exhibition brings together artists and visitors to show and see new work, and a famous exhibition can draw attention from around the world.

Break it down

LEAD: Filming is underway in Venice for 'Upgraded 2'

KEY EVENT: Camila Mendes returns as Ana Santos, with Leslie Bibb starring alongside her

+- WHO: Camila Mendes as Ana Santos, and Leslie Bibb, whose role is not yet indicated

+- WHEN: Cameras started rolling in Venice on October 21

+- WHAT NEXT: Ana is seemingly seeking to make her mark at the Venice Biennale

BACKGROUND: The first film and its story

+- ANA: An intern at a New York City auction house who pretends to hold a higher job after an upgrade to first class on a flight to London

+- WILLIAM: A wealthy young Englishman played by Archie Renaux, connected to the high-society art world

+- TONE: The sequel is described as a modern-day 'Cinderella' tale

PRODUCTION: Becca Gleason directs, taking over from Carlson Young, with a screenplay by Luke Roberts and Justin Matthews

VENICE LOCATIONS: The terrace of Ca' Giustinian, the neo-Gothic Palazzo Franchetti near the Accademia bridge, and the Moro Venice restaurant

NEXT STEP: After 12 days on the lagoon, principal photography moves to Rome for 33 more days, according to Italy for Movies

Why it matters

Filming on location shows how a real city and its art world can shape a story, and sequels let audiences follow characters they already know into a new setting.

Test what you remember

1. Who is returning as Ana Santos in 'Upgraded 2'?

- (A) Camila Mendes
- (B) Leslie Bibb
- (C) Becca Gleason
- (D) Carlson Young

2. Where is filming for 'Upgraded 2' underway?

- (A) Rome
- (B) New York City
- (C) Venice
- (D) London

3. When did cameras start rolling in Venice for the sequel?

- (A) October 12
- (B) October 21
- (C) October 23
- (D) October 33

4. In the sequel, what is Ana seemingly seeking to do?

- (A) To make her mark at the Venice Biennale
- (B) To become an auction house intern
- (C) To move to London
- (D) To direct the film

5. Who is directing the sequel?

- (A) Luke Roberts
- (B) Carlson Young
- (C) Justin Matthews
- (D) Becca Gleason

6. After shooting in Venice, where will principal photography move, and for how many more days?

- (A) To London for 12 days
- (B) To Rome for 33 more days
- (C) To New York City for 21 days
- (D) To Venice for 33 more days

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: B 4: A 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):